

Instructions for Livestreaming Conventions

March 2026

Contents

- 1 Introduction
- 2 Policy and Protocol
- 3 Technical Instructions

© 2026 Watch Tower Bible and Tract Society of Pennsylvania

CO-162-E

CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

1. Convention Committees can use JW Stream to provide the program to publishers unable to attend in person and to departments within the venue when approved by the branch office.
2. When providing the program to **departments within the venue**, a direct **cable connection from the video desk remains the preferred option**. If it is feasible to run a cable, this should be done to ensure a stable and high-quality feed. Streaming should be used for departments when a direct connection is not practical.
3. This document outlines the policy and procedural responsibilities as well as technical information for Convention Committees, audio/video overseers, and information technology overseers.

CHAPTER 2: POLICY AND PROTOCOL

Contents

Streaming Configurations 1-3
Streaming Methods 4-5
Convention Committee 6-7
Audio/Video Overseer 8
Congregation Elders 9
Streaming Preparation Timeline 10-14

STREAMING CONFIGURATIONS

1. Streaming can be configured in two ways:
 - (1) Onsite Streaming: Used for internal needs within the venue, such as isolated departments requiring access to the program.
 - (2) Offsite Streaming: Provides access for publishers unable to attend in person. Elders will have the ability to share a link with such persons.
2. The Service Department determines whether a convention program will be streamed and which configuration is permitted. (Depending on the situation, both configurations may be permitted.) Convention Committees should wait for confirmation of this direction before making any arrangements.
3. The Local Broadcasting Department (LBD) manages streaming configurations. Direct any technical questions to the LBD.

STREAMING METHODS

4. There are two video streaming methods available for livestreams of local conventions: broadcast stream and real-time stream. Broadcast streams are slightly delayed and incur a low data cost for the organization. Links generated by elders to send to publishers are used to view broadcast streams. Real-time streams have no discernible delay. They incur a higher data cost for the organization than broadcast streams.
5. In order to save dedicated funds, use broadcast streams whenever possible. Only 25 real-time connections are available for each convention. The following examples are acceptable uses for real-time streams.—See 3:4.
 - (1) To provide a live program feed to the chairman's office or the Convention Committee office, if a wired feed is not practical. The brothers working in these offices must be able to monitor the program in real time.
 - (2) To provide a live program feed to a department located in an area where the loudspeakers from the main auditorium can be heard.

CONVENTION COMMITTEE

6. The Convention Committee makes sure that the streaming arrangements are in harmony with direction from the branch office and that all responsible brothers understand how the arrangements should be handled.
7. The Convention Committee should work with department overseers to ensure that volunteers who view broadcast streams enter "0" in the attendance field when they connect on

JW Stream. Congregations that were originally assigned to attend the convention but received permission to tie in to the program should not use JW Stream to report the count of those tied in at the Kingdom Hall or another remote location. The Convention Committee coordinator should ensure that the attendance figures obtained from JW Stream are included in the attendance figures on the *Postconvention Report* (CO-62).—See *Convention Organization Guidelines* (CO-1), chapter 1, paragraph 16.

AUDIO/VIDEO OVERSEER

8. The audio/video overseer works closely with the information technology overseer to ensure that they have everything needed to set up and manage the stream effectively.

CONGREGATION ELDERS

9. Elders ensure that the stream link is provided to those in their congregation in harmony with the latest direction from the organization. They arrange to provide technical assistance as needed.

STREAMING PREPARATION TIMELINE

10. After the Service Department has sent the approved streaming configurations to the Convention Committee

- (1) The audio/video (AV) overseer ensures that the AV equipment needed to send a stream will be in place.
- (2) The AV overseer assigns the information technology (IT) overseer the “Manager” role on JW Stream.—See 3:3.
- (3) The IT overseer assigns the “Streamer” role to brothers who are responsible to monitor the stream.—See 3:3.
- (4) The IT overseer creates a schedule of brothers who will be assigned to monitor the streaming computer during the program. Because of the way that JW Stream is accessed, one brother should monitor the stream for the full day so that there is no need to switch logins between brothers.

11. No more than 30 days before the start of the convention

- (1) The AV overseer confirms that the visibility setting for the event in JW Stream is set to “Visible” for each event and language that is approved for streaming.—See 3:2.

12. One week before the start of the convention

- (1) The IT overseer confirms that all key personnel are assigned the correct roles on JW Stream and verifies that all brothers responsible to monitor the stream can log in and view the stream meeting interface.—See 3:3.
- (2) The IT overseer creates and distributes a real-time link for each department approved by the Convention Committee.

13. During setup day

- (1) A member of the AV Department sets up the stream computer. It should be located close to the video desk when possible. If the Internet connection is located a long distance from the video desk, an effort should be made to provide a long network cable (as opposed to a long SDI cable) so the IT crew can be located close to the rest of the brothers in the AV Department. A wired Internet connection is preferred for the

streaming computer whenever possible. If a wired connection is not available, a private wireless network should be used.

- (2) The IT crew tests the stream once the AV system is available. This should be done by playing the first song (not the musical prelude) included in the convention playlist. Since the stream will be visible to anyone with the link, proper decorum should be maintained during testing.—See 3:6-8.

14. Day of the convention

- (1) The IT overseer or someone he designates should reset the attendance on JW Stream each day before the broadcast stream starts. (See 3:9-12.) The attendant overseer will request the streaming attendance at the same time the in-person count is taken.—See *Convention Organization Guidelines* (CO-1), chapter 3, paragraph 17.
- (2) The IT overseer ensures that the stream is started well before the public is allowed into the venue.
- (3) A brother assigned by the IT overseer monitors the streaming computer throughout the day.
- (4) A brother assigned by the IT overseer periodically checks the broadcast stream throughout the day to ensure that audio and video are present.

CHAPTER 3: TECHNICAL INSTRUCTIONS

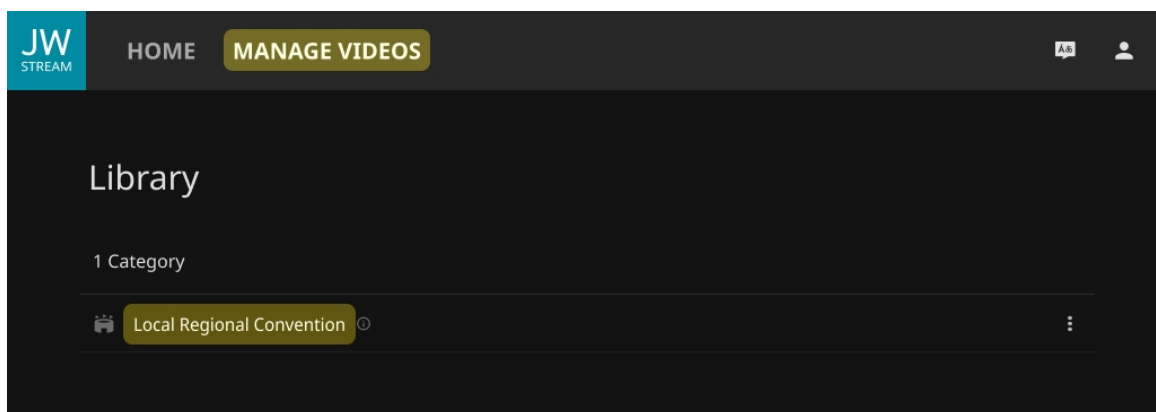
Contents

Find a Convention in JW Stream 1
Confirm the Convention is Visible on JW Stream 2
Create and Verify Permissions 3
Create Links for the Stream 4
Send Links to the Stream 5
Starting the Stream 6-8
Collecting and Resetting Attendance 9-12
Handling Technical Issues 13-16

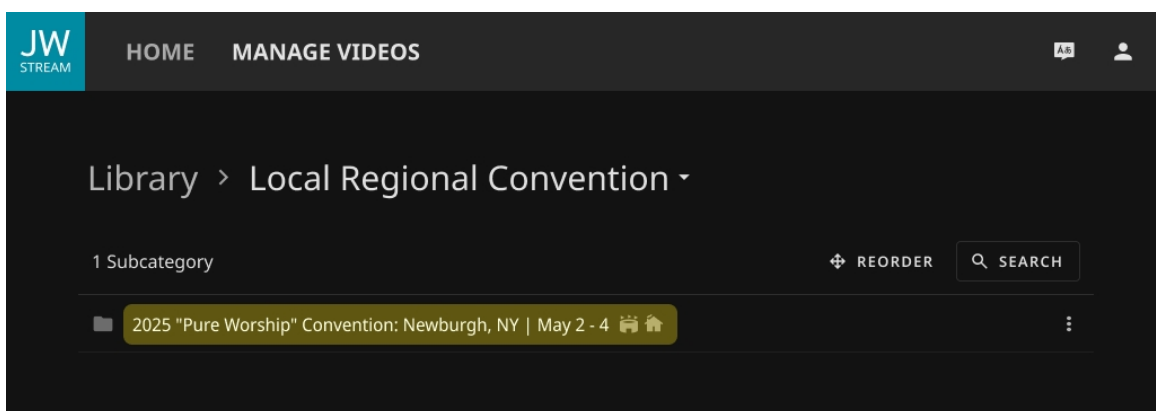
FIND A CONVENTION IN JW STREAM

1. Each of the tasks in these instructions require locating a specific convention in JW Stream. Follow these steps to locate a convention:

- (1) Log in to JW Stream.
- (2) Click “MANAGE VIDEOS.”
- (3) Under Library, click the category “Local Regional Convention.”



- (4) One or more conventions will appear in a list.

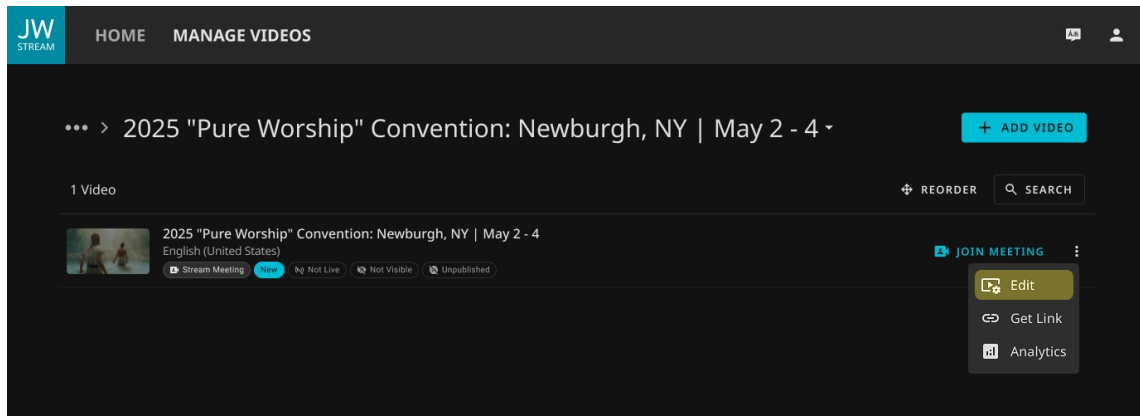


CONFIRM THE CONVENTION IS VISIBLE ON JW STREAM

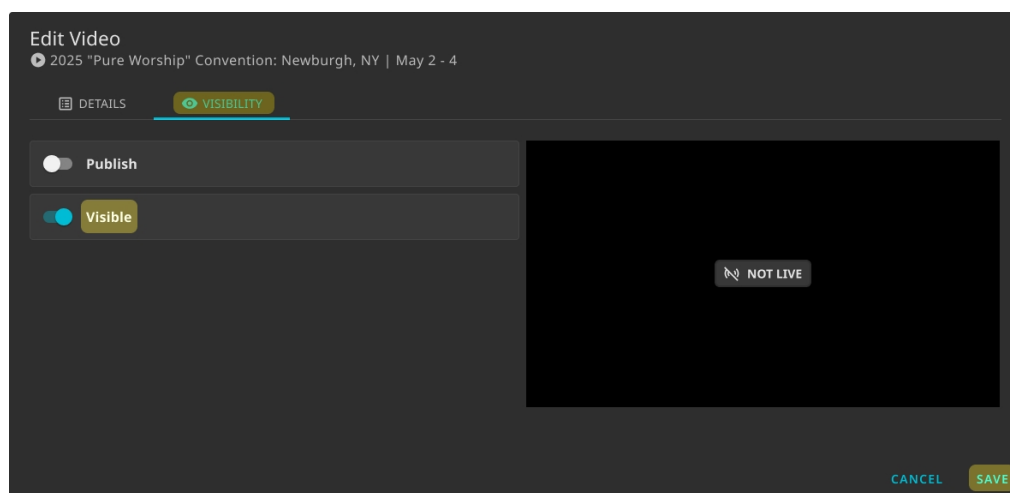
2. Follow these steps to confirm the convention is visible on JW Stream:

- (1) Locate and click on your convention. (See 3:1.) If more than one convention appears, ensure you select the correct one.

(2) Click the ellipsis on the right side of the screen and click “Edit.”



(3) Navigate to the VISIBILITY tab and confirm that the toggle next to “Visible” is turned on. Do not adjust other settings in the VISIBILITY tab unless directed to do so by the Local Broadcasting Department.



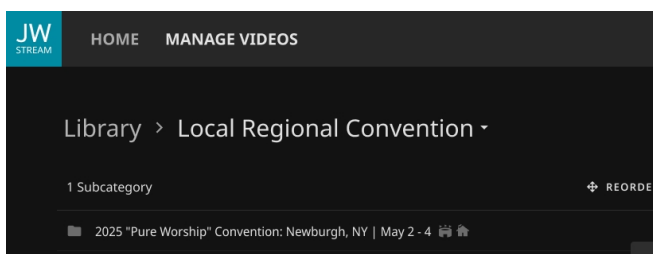
(4) Click “SAVE.”

CREATE AND VERIFY PERMISSIONS

3. Create permissions for those who will serve as stream technicians for the convention and verify that necessary brothers have correct permissions. Permissions can be added, edited, or removed at any time.

(1) Locate your convention.—See 3:1.

(2) Click the ellipsis icon on the right side of the convention, then click “Permissions.”



- (3) To create permissions, type the jwpub.org email address of the person who will receive permissions in the “Add People or Groups” field. Click the “+” icon.

Permissions
■ 2025 "Pure Worship" Convention: Newburgh, NY | May 2 - 4

Add People or Groups
mjohnson@jwpub.org +

Enter an individual or an AD group.

Who can access (2) SEARCH

- USA-BRDCST-JWSTREAMAdmins Manager
- USA-lbd-jwstreamadmins Manager

CANCEL SAVE

- (4) In the “Select Permission” dropdown box, choose the correct permission:
- Streamer: Assigned to stream technicians who start, monitor, and stop the stream.
 - Manager: Assigned to Convention Committee members, the AV overseer, and the IT overseer.

Permissions
■ 2025 "Pure Worship" Convention: Newburgh, NY | May 2 - 4

Add People or Groups +

Enter an individual or an AD group.

Who can access (4) SEARCH

- mjohnson@jwpub.org
Streamer, English
Select Permission: Streamer
Select Languages: English
REMOVE
- USA-BRDCST-JWSTREAMAdmins Manager
- USA-lbd-jwstreamadmins Manager
- WHQ-BRDCST-JWSTREAMStagingUSA Manager

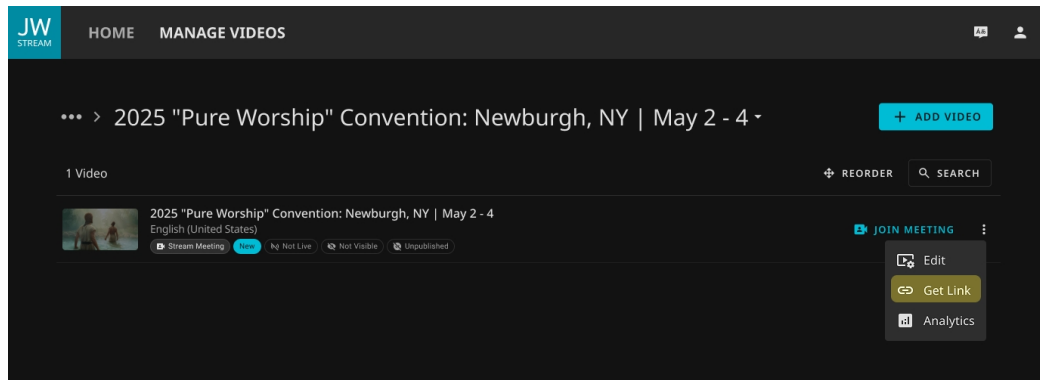
CANCEL SAVE

- (5) If the Streamer permission is selected, an additional dropdown box will appear to select languages. Select the correct language(s) of the convention that the streamer will support.
- (6) Click “SAVE.” Repeat steps 3-5 to grant permissions to more individuals.

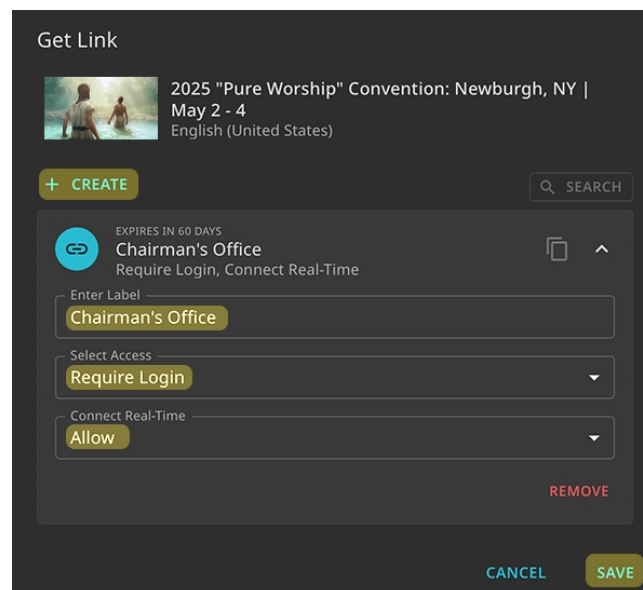
CREATE LINKS FOR THE STREAM

4. Follow these steps to create links that will be used by departments and volunteers to connect to the stream. See Chapter 2, paragraphs 4-5, for information about the types of streams. Links can be created or removed at any time.

- (1) Locate and click on your convention (See 3:1.) If more than one convention appears, ensure you select the correct one.
- (2) Click the ellipsis on the right side of the screen and click “Get Link.”



- (3) Click “+ CREATE” in the Get Link dialog box.
- (4) Create a real-time stream link: To improve security, create a unique real-time stream link for each department that will connect to the broadcast stream.
 - Enter a meaningful name in the “Enter Label” field, such as the name of a person or a role at the convention.
 - In the “Select Access” field, choose “Require Login.” An individual in the department using this link must log in with a valid jw.org credential to access the stream.
 - In the “Connect Real-Time” field, choose “Allow.”



- (5) Create a broadcast stream link: To improve security, create a unique broadcast stream link for each department that will connect to the broadcast stream.
 - Enter a meaningful name in the “Enter Label” field, such as the name of a department.

- In the “Select Access” field, select “Public.” Individuals who use this link do not need to enter credentials to access the stream. When this option is selected, the “Connect Real-Time” field will automatically be set to “Do not allow.”

Get Link

2025 "Pure Worship" Convention: Newburgh, NY | May 2 - 4
English (United States)

+ CREATE SEARCH

EXPIRES IN 60 DAYS
Parking Department
Public

Enter Label
Parking Department

Select Access
Public

Connect Real-Time
Do not allow

REMOVE

CANCEL SAVE

- (6) To remove a link, locate the link in the Get Link dialog box. Click the arrow on the right side of the link, then click “REMOVE.”

SEND LINKS TO THE STREAM

5. Follow these steps to send links to the stream:

- (1) Locate and click on your convention. (See 3:1.) If more than one convention appears, ensure you select the correct one.
- (2) Click the ellipsis on the right side of the screen and click “Get Link.”
- (3) Locate the link that you will send and click the “Copy Link” icon.

Get Link

2025 "Pure Worship" Convention: Newburgh, NY | May 2 - 4
English (United States)

+ CREATE SEARCH

EXPIRES IN 60 DAYS
Chairman's Office
Require Login, Connect Real-Time

CLOSE

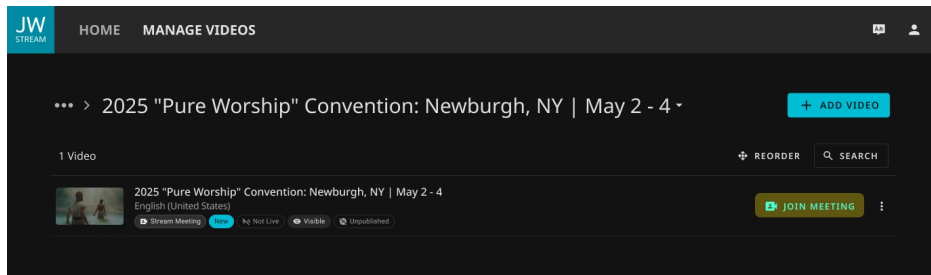
- (4) Send the link to individuals as necessary.

STARTING THE STREAM

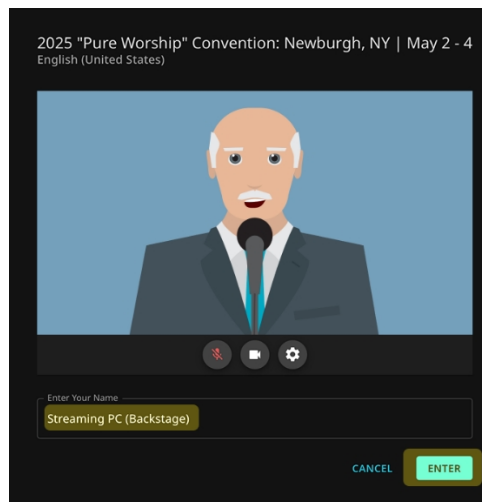
6. Start the broadcast stream:

- (1) Locate and click on your convention. (See 3:1.) If more than one convention appears, ensure you select the correct one.

(2) Click “JOIN MEETING.”

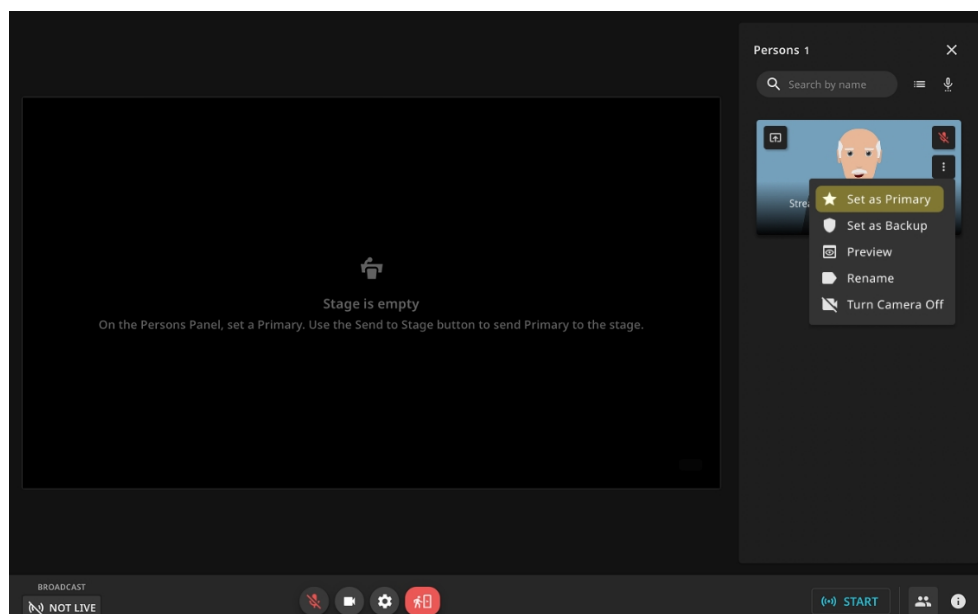


(3) In the “Enter Your Name” field, enter a meaningful name for the streaming computer.



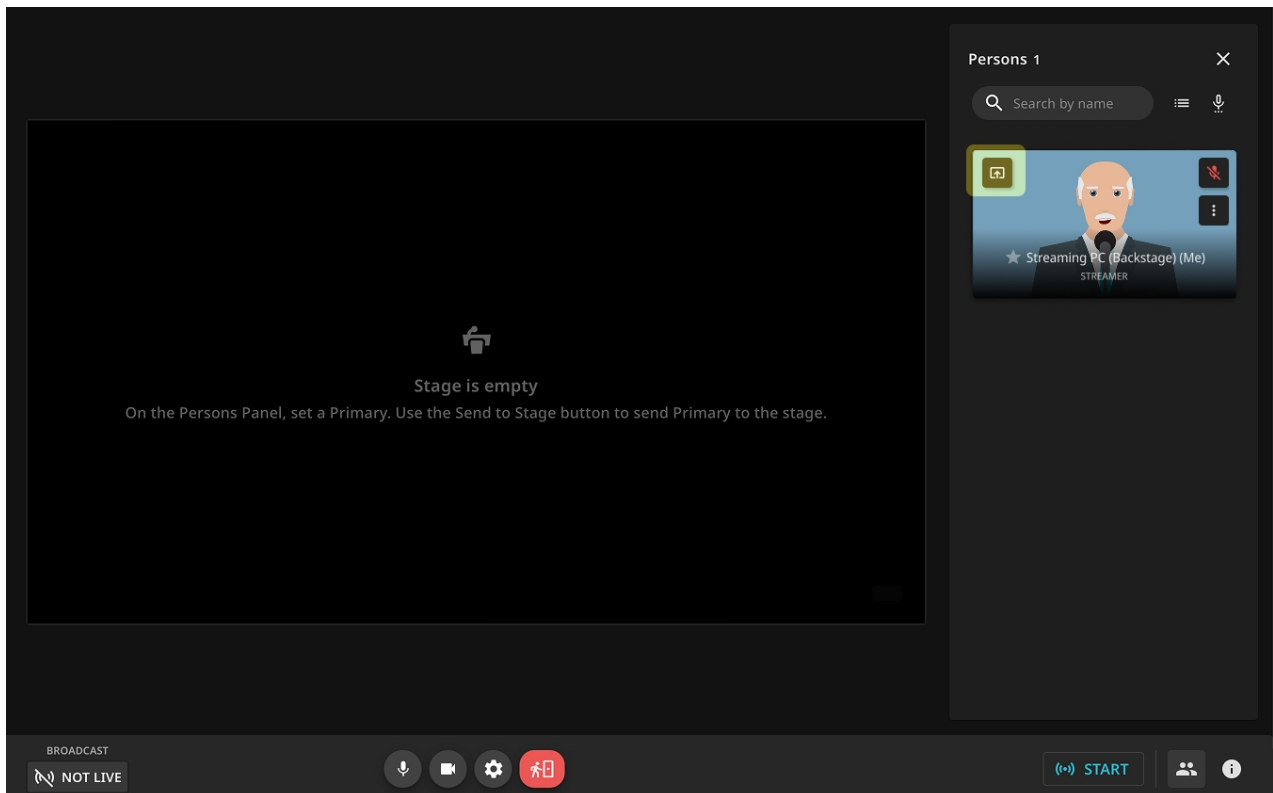
(4) Click ENTER. This begins the real-time stream. Those with real-time stream links will be able to view the stream.

(5) Click the ellipsis for the main camera input for the convention and select “Set as Primary.”

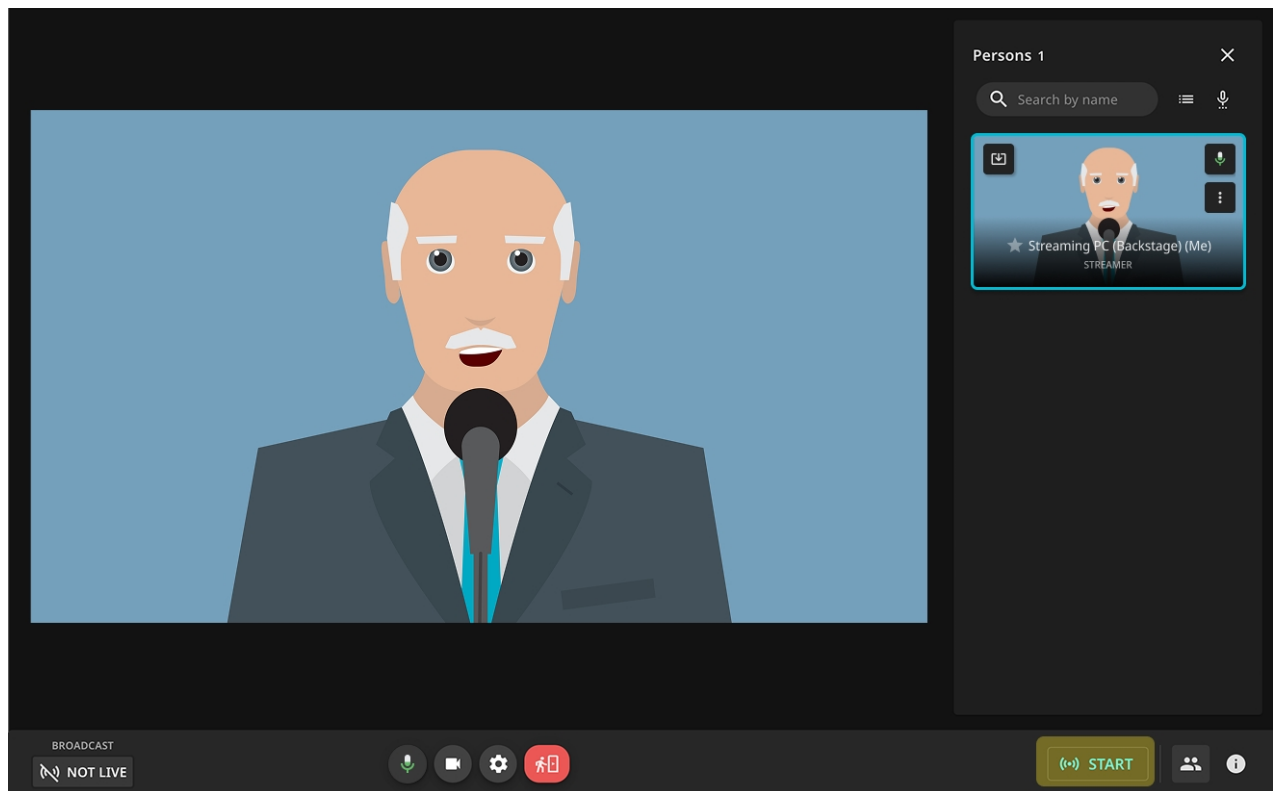


- Repeat steps 1-5 to connect a backup stream computer, if one is used. When doing step 5, select “Set as Backup.”

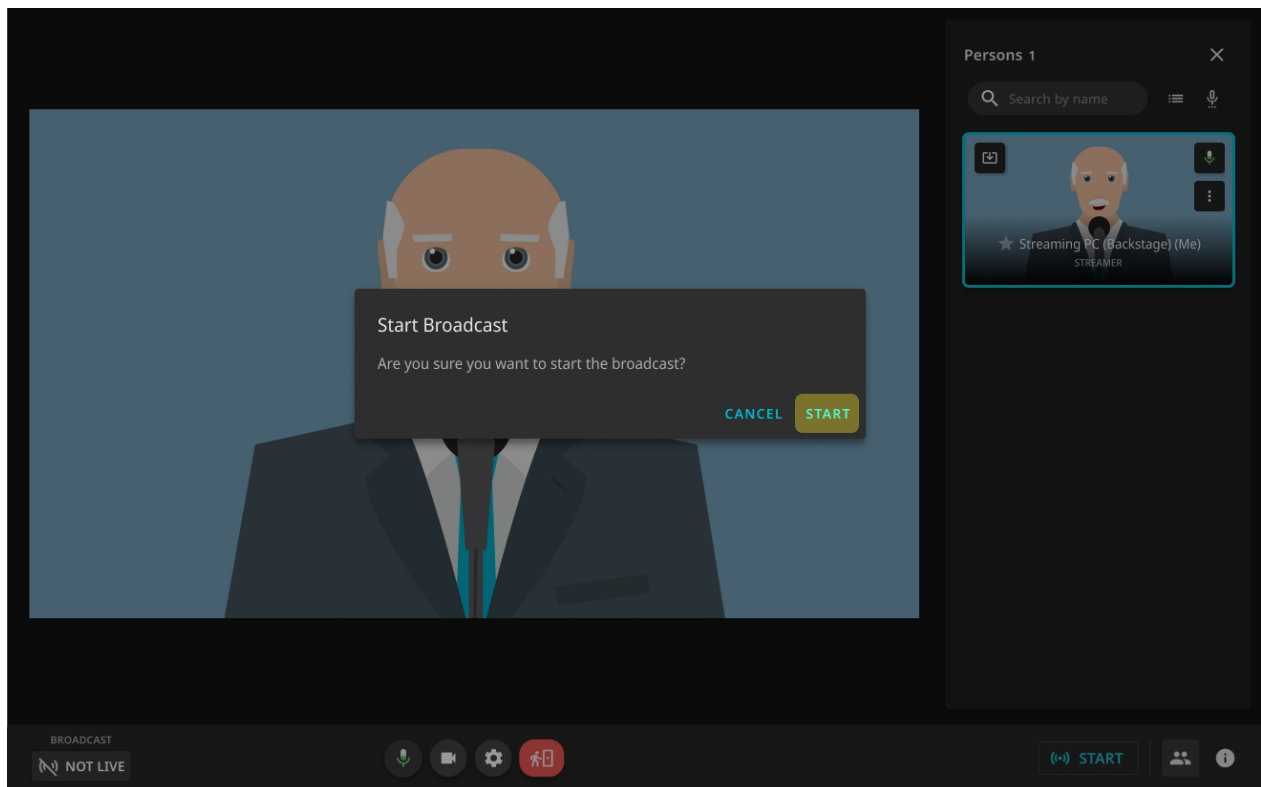
- (6) Click the “Send to Stage” icon on the camera feed to select the active source. The source will immediately appear on real-time streams.



- (7) Click “START” to broadcast the stream. The streaming computer’s screen will show “Broadcast Live” in the bottom left corner when the broadcast stream is live.

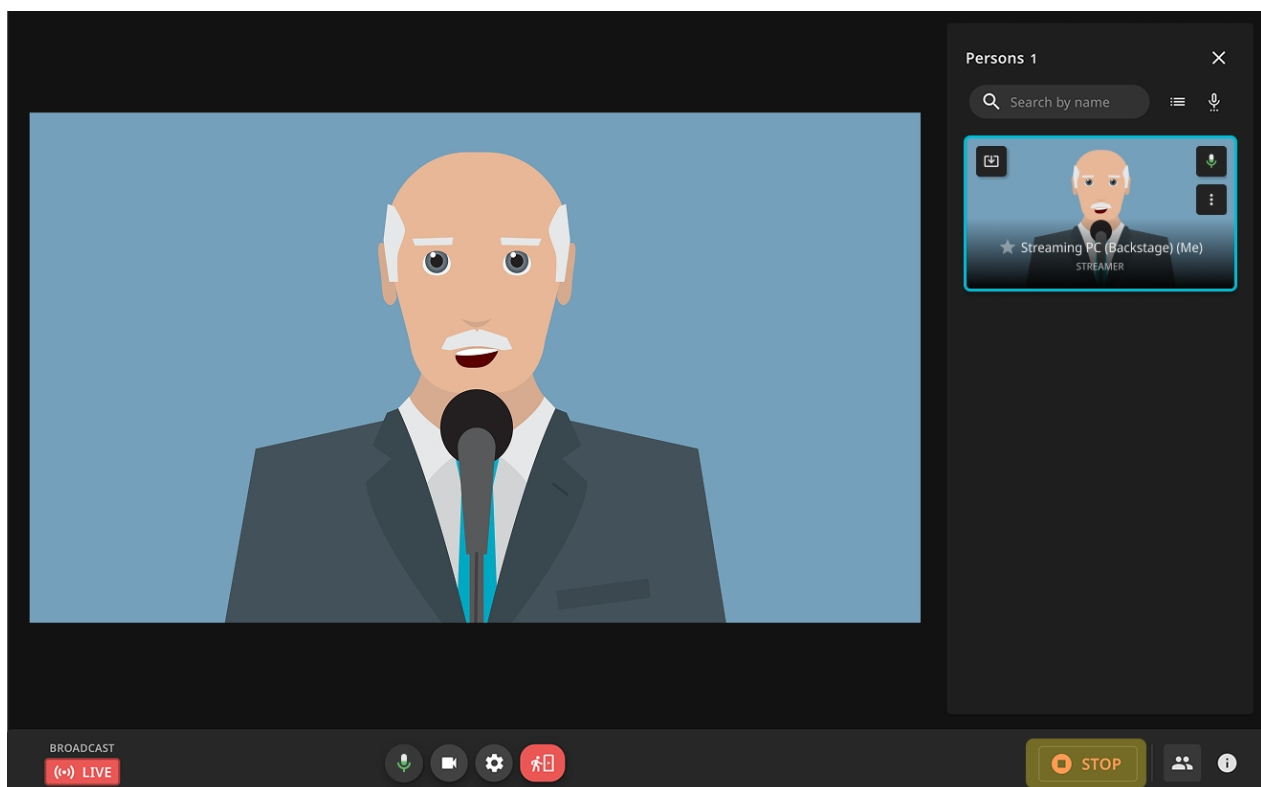


(8) Click “START” in the Start Broadcast dialog box to confirm and start the stream.



7. After a few minutes, the source will become visible to the homebound and those using a broadcast link to access the stream.

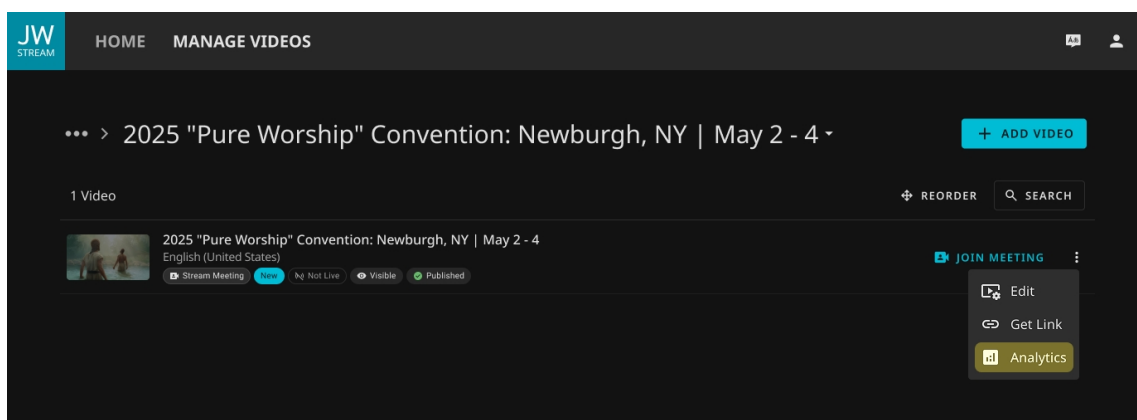
8. To stop broadcasting the stream, click “STOP.” After all sources have been disconnected from the stream meeting for one hour, the real-time stream will automatically end.



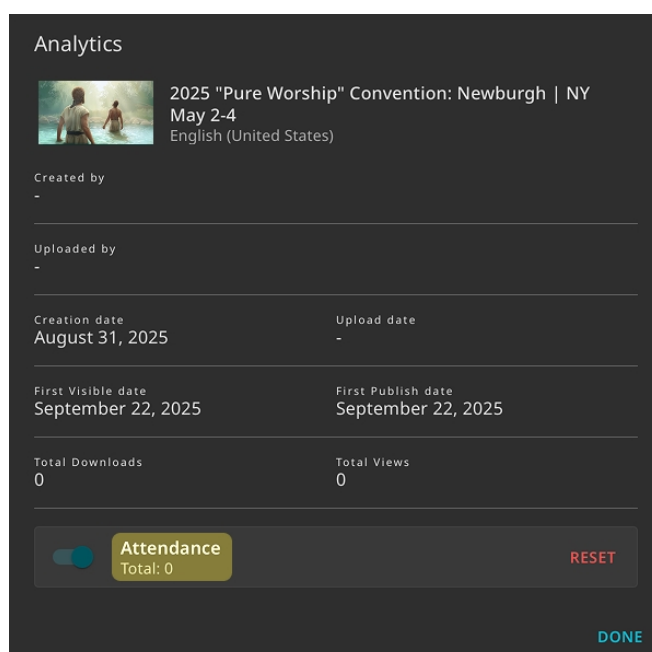
COLLECTING AND RESETTING ATTENDANCE

9. Locate and click on your convention. (See 3:1.) If more than one convention appears, ensure you select the correct one.

10. Select the ellipsis on the right side of the screen and select “Analytics.”



11. Provide the attendance figure that is displayed on the screen to the attendant overseer when it is requested.



12. Before starting the broadcast stream each morning, select the “Reset” button to reset the attendance figure to zero.

HANDLING TECHNICAL ISSUES

13. Direct technical questions to the Local Broadcasting Department, which manages streaming configurations.

14. JW Stream allows a connection to both a primary and backup computer. This feature allows the backup feed to immediately display to the audience in case of failure. When the broadcast stream goes live, the primary and backup roles cannot be changed on the JW Stream interface unless the broadcast stream is stopped.

15. If both the primary and backup computers are disconnected from the meeting, remote viewers will see a black screen. If the primary or backup computer is reconnected without stopping the stream, viewers will see the stream again. If the broadcast stream is stopped, they will see a screen that informs them that they are connected and that the stream has not started. When the broadcast stream is restarted, a “Play Now” button will appear. Viewers can select “Play Now” to resume watching the stream.

16. When stream issues occur, identify whether hardware or network problems caused the disruption. Minor problems caused by intermittent network issues, such as the stream stuttering every so often, may be tolerable. Hardware issues, such as computer or SDI ingest device failure, may require the following troubleshooting steps:

(1) Both primary and backup streaming computers equipped with SDI ingest devices:

- When the primary computer fails and the backup computer continues to function, select the “Send to stage” icon on the backup computer to make it the active source.
- If both computers fail or become disconnected, reboot both computers. Log in to the meeting again on both computers. Stop the broadcast stream. Restart the stream.

(2) Both the primary and backup streaming computer connected to the meeting but only the primary has an SDI ingest device:

- When the primary computer fails and the backup computer continues to be connected to the meeting, disconnect the SDI ingest device from the primary computer and connect it to the backup computer.
- On the backup computer, select the gear icon and select the SDI ingest device as the camera and microphone.
- Select the “Send to stage” icon on the backup computer to make it the active source.

(3) If you have only one streaming computer:

- When the streaming computer fails and the network continues to function, restart the computer if possible. If necessary, locate a backup computer.

17. Log in to JW Stream and navigate to the meeting. Stop the broadcast stream. Restart the stream. Sometimes, in rare cases, the venue’s Internet connection gives the Windows computer direct access to the public Internet. For security reasons, this is not ideal. An easy way to reduce risk is to connect the computer through a simple, locally purchased home router instead of connecting it directly. You can determine if the Windows computer is connected directly to the public Internet by checking to see if its assigned IP address is on a public or private subnet.